

MACV-US / MAAG RECORD EXTRACT #RSZ-5519-DELTA
MAAG Vietnam Advisory File
DATE RANGE: MAY-NOV 1955

This extract concerns U.S. Military Assistance Advisory Group participation in South Vietnamese operations against the Binh Xuyen during 1955. Advisory personnel were attached to ARVN and RVN Marine elements during actions in Cholon, the Saigon river approaches, and the Rung Sat Special Zone.

The operation was officially framed as support to the Government of Vietnam in restoring control over areas held or influenced by Binh Xuyen paramilitary forces.

Several reports also reference a parallel objective embedded within the broader action. The restricted material is not indexed under narcotics, counterinsurgency, or police operations. Descriptions are inconsistent and include the terms "adjacent networks," and "sanitation targets."

Cholon / Riverfront Action

RVN and supporting units conducted searches against warehouses, canal-front structures, gambling houses, and suspected Binh Xuyen holding sites throughout Cholon. U.S. advisers note difficulty separating ordinary Chinese commercial activity, criminal supply chains, and hostile support networks.

Rung Sat Special Zone Action

Later reporting shifts to the Rung Sat Special Zone, where Binh Xuyen remnants were confirmed to converge. RVN Marine elements moved by water under advisory guidance.

Reports are fragmented. Multiple entries reference poor maps, unreliable channels, lost contact with forward elements, and air support being called against locations that could not be cleanly reconciled with available charting.

One air-support notation reads:

"NAPE DIRECT ON BEACON REF. DANGER CLOSE. (...) TARGET PLAINLY VISIBLE. BURN IT NOW!"

One RVNAF pilot radio-log fragment records the following (translated):

"RADAR NOT FUNCTIONAL. I DON'T KNOW WHERE I AM. CLOSING IN ON GROUND BEACON SIGNAL (...) GOD (...) I SEE IT."

A later correction adds:

"Coordinates removed from general distribution. See restricted annex RSZ-5520-DELTA."

Advisory Personnel

The following MAAG adviser appears repeatedly in field-action traffic, radio logs, and post-action medical records:

CAPT. WALTER D. FIELDEN, USMC

Attached MAAG Vietnam, advisory support to RVN Marine elements.

Prior service: Korea.

1955 assignment: RVN Marine liaison / field adviser, Cholon and Rung Sat actions.

Fielden is referenced in connection with:

- RVN Marine river movement into the Rung Sat.
- Forward radio coordination during restricted target action.
- Air-support requests against two redacted or disputed target areas, one specific request being guided by his personal radio beacon.
- Recovery of surviving personnel after loss of navigation and communications reliability.
- Medical evacuation following September 1955 Rung Sat action.

Another entry, attached to post-action review:

"FIELDEN reports overwhelming enemy presence on site and requests DANGER CLOSE air support. Loses consciousness following injury. RVN and attached elements retreat and regroup."

Medical / Administrative Disposition

Captain Fielden was removed from advisory duties following the September action and returned to U.S. medical control. File indicates:

NOV 1955 – Medical discharge proceedings initiated.

Causes listed as complications following tropical infection, lower-leg trauma, and nervous exhaustion.

The medical language is vague and appears to have been administratively softened. A later notation refers to "persistent tissue abnormality" and "recurring fever without identifiable parasitic load." No full medical file is attached.

Fielden's name does not appear in later MACV assignments.

Post-Service Trace

A later intelligence annotation, probably added a couple of years ago, places Fielden in Cholon under a commercial identity.

WALTER D. FIELDEN

Commercial: "WDC IMPORT & REPAIR" -> surplus, repair, pawn, military goods

Area: Cholon, Saigon

Status: living.